GARDEN CITY CHURCH

MINISTRY LEADERS MANUAL

TABLE OF CONTENTS

INTRODUCTION	1
MISSION, VISION, VALUES	2
SPIRITUAL EXPECTATIONS	3
PERSONAL LIFE EXPECTATIONS	4
PARTICIPATION IN CHURCH CULTURE	5
UNDERSTANDING YOUR ROLE	6
TRAINING AND DEVELOPMENT	8
CONCLUSION	8

INTRODUCTION

Welcome to the Garden City Church Ministry Leadership Team! We are thrilled to have you join us in our mission to spread the love and message of Jesus Christ through the various ministry outlets within our church. This manual will guide you through our expectations, your role, and how we work together to achieve our mission. If you are reading this, you have been identified as a leader within our church. One of the jobs of the pastoral team is to encourage and develop the leadership gifting and talents within you. Whether you serve with youth, children, facilities, worship, media, or any other department within our church, we all have a role to play in ministering to our church community.

Thank you for your service,
Pastor Aaron Rios



MISSION, VISION, AND VALUES

MISSION AND VISION

Mission: To know Christ and make Him known in our city and in every nation.
And he said to them, "Go into all the world and proclaim the gospel to the whole creation. Whoever believes and is baptized will be saved, but whoever does not believe will be condemned. - Mark 16:15-16

Vision: Live the life. Tell the story.
Live the Life speaks to the internal work of God's Holy Spirit in the hearts and lives of God's Children. *"Do you not know that you are God's temple and that God's Spirit dwells in you?" - 1 Corinthians 3:16*

Tell the story speaks to the external work - sometimes called "evangelism." God does a great work in the hearts of His Children, and we have been called to share the story of Jesus with every living creature.

OUR VALUES

BIBLICALLY GROUNDED

The Bible is our ultimate authority, serving as our manual and foundation. We believe in the dependability and truthfulness of the Word of God, evidenced by personal testimony and historical data. Over the course of 1,500+ years, the Bible has been canonized and preserved, with more evidence for its authenticity than any other literature in antiquity. The Bible reveals God's truth to humanity and teaches us the path to salvation.

COMMUNITY DRIVEN

Inspired by Matthew 25:31-46, we prioritize serving and caring for one another, recognizing that our actions towards fellow believers reflect our commitment to Christ. By equipping our community, we can extend our support and ministry, enabling believers to participate fully in the mission of the church - reaching the ends of the world.

MISSION & EVANGELISM ORIENTED

Our mission is to make disciples of all nations, baptizing them and teaching them to obey Christ's commands (Matthew 28:19-20, Mark 16:15-16). We recognize evangelism as a fundamental responsibility of every believer, and endeavor to share the message of Christ with others.

PENTECOSTAL/ HOLY SPIRIT EMPOWERED

We embrace the power of the Holy Spirit in balance and order, as demonstrated in the Bible. Acts 2 dem-onstrates the early church experiencing supernatural manifestations such as healing, deliverance, and bold proclamations of the Word, and we believe that is still relevant for today's church. Our community is committed to welcoming the gifts of the Spirit and passionately pursuing God's agenda. We strive to maintain an environment aligned with the activities and approval of the Holy Spirit.

RELATIONALLY NURTURING

Rooted in 1 John 4:7-8, we emphasize the importance of love within our community, understanding that our health as a church is directly linked to our ability to love one another.

GENEROUS

Ephesians 2:4-10 reminds us of God's generosity towards us, motivating us to be generous in return. Generosity is both an act of obedience to God and a means through which the mission of the church is accomplished (Proverbs 11:25, Matthew 10:8, Luke 6:38).

PURSUING EXCELLENCE

By the grace of God, we seek to grow in our continual pursuit of a higher standard in all aspects of our lives, as exemplified throughout Scripture (2 Corinthians 8, Ephesians 4:1-3, 2 Timothy 2:15, Colossians 3:23-24).

SPIRITUAL EXPECTATIONS

While serving at Garden City Church you are a representative of not only the Lord Jesus Christ, but also His people. You represent Garden City Church and its values. We expect all volunteers to:

MAINTAIN A PERSONAL RELATIONSHIP WITH JESUS

- This entails regular prayer, Bible study, and participation in church services.
- Join us at least twice a month for Tuesday prayer and at least once a week for morning prayer, so we can grow spiritually as a community.

DEMONSTRATE CHRISTIAN CHARACTER

- Exhibit love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, and self-control.

COMMITMENT TO GROWTH

- This includes consistent and faithful church attendance and commitment to giving.
- You are to actively attend the discipleship classes offered at Garden City Church in addition to presenting other opportunities* such as conferences, services, or other activities that provide opportunities for continual spiritual growth. **Occasionally, Garden City Church may cover the cost to attend various events.*



PERSONAL LIFE EXPECTATIONS

In addition to reflecting Christ-like character, your personal life should align with the mission, vision, and values of Garden City Church. The Bible instructs us to live beyond reproach (1 Timothy 5:7) and avoid all appearances of evil (1 Thessalonians 5:22-23). We believe it is essential to strive to live a model life for the sake of our community both inside and outside of the church. For instance, how can we effectively lead an alcoholic to deliverance and freedom if we ourselves are held captive by addiction? Likewise, how can we help others maintain healthy relationships if we are not gracious and forgiving? Because of this, we must strive to live a life worthy of our calling.

We expect our leaders to:

LIVE WITH INTEGRITY

- Your actions should match your words. Avoid behavior that could be a stumbling block to others. Follow through with your commitment to serve, and perform above the standard that you hold others to.
  - *"In everything set them an example by doing what is good. In your teaching, show integrity, seriousness."* Titus 2:7 (NIV).

PRACTICE ACCOUNTABILITY

- Be open to correction, teachable, and able to receive guidance from church leadership.
  - *"As iron sharpens iron, so one person sharpens another."* Proverbs 27:17 (NIV)
  - *"Submit to one another out of reverence for Christ."* Ephesians 5:21 (NIV)

MAINTAIN HEALTHY RELATIONSHIPS

- All leaders should be quick to forgive, never engaging in contentious behaviors. Strive for peace and reconciliation in all relationships [see page 6].
  - *"Be kind and compassionate to one another, forgiving each other, just as in Christ God forgave you."* Ephesians 4:32 (NIV)
  - "*Make every effort to live in peace with everyone and to be holy; without holiness no one will see the Lord."* Hebrews 12:14 (NIV)

DEMONSTRATE FAITHFULNESS TO THE HOUSE

- It is expected that all leaders will attend church faithfully, promote the ministries, attend special gatherings when possible, give tithes and offerings, support missions faithfully, and encourage others to walk faithfully towards the mission and vision of Garden City Church.
  - *"And let us consider how we may spur one another on toward love and good deeds, not giving up meeting together, as some are in the habit of doing, but encouraging one another - and all the more as you see the Day approaching."* Hebrews 10:24-25
  - *"Bring the whole tithe into the storehouse, that there may be food in my house. Test me in this,' says the Lord Almighty, "and see if I will not throw open the floodgates of heaven and pour out so much blessing that there will be not room enough to store it."* Malachi 3:10

THESE EXPECTATIONS HELP ENSURE THAT WE CAN LEAD OTHERS EFFECTIVELY AND HONOR GOD IN OUR PERSONAL LIVES.

PARTICIPATION IN CHURCH CULTURE



All leaders are expected to be current in their next steps within our discipleship process, and encourage those who serve under them to also be current in theirs. We want to adopt the language of encouraging people to walk towards their 'Next steps.' Next steps are the pathway to thriving in our community. It brings unity and cohesion, and keeps everyone well informed.

NEXT STEPS INCLUDE...

- Next Night
- Following Jesus
- Connecting with a CORE Minister
- Holy Spirit Class
- Authentic Discipleship
- Truth Trek

Discipleship	Serving	Learning
Join a small group for Bible Study, prayer, and fellowship.	Find a place within the church that matches your gifts and passions.	Participate in church workshops, seminars, and conferences to deepen your faith.

UNDERSTANDING YOUR ROLE

JOB DESCRIPTIONS

Each volunteer position has a specific job description outlining responsibilities and expectations. Before you or a team member can serve, they must:

1. **Receive a Ministry Job Description** - Understand the specific duties and expectations for the role.
2. **Complete Proper Training:** Be properly trained in their area of service.
3. **Utilize Scheduling Management Software** - Use Garden City Church's scheduling management software and other relevant tools.
4. **Complete the Onboarding Process** - All volunteers must be onboarded, shadowed by an experienced team member, thoroughly vetted, and then given a ministry covenant to sign.

ALL VOLUNTEERS SHOULD CLEARLY UNDERSTAND WHAT IS EXPECTED OF THEM AND BE GIVEN THE TOOLS NECESSARY TO SUCCEED.

TRAINING

Attend all required training sessions, stay informed about updates related to your role, and actively grow your knowledge and skill in the area you serve. Continuous learning and improvement are key to effective service.

TEAM COLLABORATION

work cooperatively with other volunteers and staff members, maintaining open and respectful communication. Teamwork and mutual support are essential for a thriving ministry environment.

CONFLICT RESOLUTION

Conflict is inevitable, but must be handled in a Christ-like manner. Our process includes:

- **Direct Communication**: Address the person involved directly, with love and respect. Listen with the intent to understand, not to give a defense.
- **Seek Mediation:** If direct communication fails, seek the help of a church leader for mediation.
- **Forgiveness**: Practice forgiveness and seek reconciliation, remembering that we are all part of the body of Christ.

Conflict Resolution Process

When a conflict arises, consider the following steps to address the situation:

- **Reflect** - Think about what happened and how it made you feel.
- **Ask Questions** - Seek to understand the other person's perspective by asking questions. For example, "Why did you not greet me?"
- **State Your Needs** - Clearly express what you need to resolve the conflict. For instance, "I feel hurt when you didn't greet me. I would appreciate an apology."

EXAMPLE OF APPROPRIATE RESPONSE TO CONFLICT:

1. **Expressing Feelings:** John communicates his feelings, even if not very articulately.
    - John: "You didn't greet me this morning. That really hurt."
2. **Acknowledging the Impact:** You should acknowledge the impact of your actions without becoming defensive and seek to understand John's feelings.
    - You: "I'm really sorry, John. I didn't realize that not greeting you would hurt your feelings. I was preoccupied with something else, but I understand how important it is to acknowledge each other."
3. **Seeking Understanding:** Ensure that both parties understand each other's perspectives and provide reassurance.
    - You: "I appreciate you telling me this. I didn't mean to overlook you, and I'll make sure to greet you properly in the future. Your feelings are important to me."
4. **Apologizing and Making Amends:** Offer a sincere apology and suggest ways to prevent similar issues in the future.
    - You: "I truly apologize for making you feel that way. From now on, I'll be more mindful and make sure to greet you, even if I'm busy."
5. **Acceptance and Moving Forward:** Help John feel heard and appreciated, focusing on moving forward positively.
    - John: "Okay, thanks."
    - You: "Thank you for understanding, John. Let's both make an effort to communicate better in the future."

TRAINING AND DEVELOPMENT

Training and development is vital to the success of you and your team. When we stop learning, we stop growing. There are three levels of training to ensure your ministry thrives:

INITIAL TRAINING
Comprehensive training when you start your role to equip you with the necessary skills and knowledge to promote success. This includes the orientation, onboarding, and a trial time of serving in your role.

ONGOING DEVELOPMENT
Regular training sessions, workshops, goal setting, and feedback to ensure continuous improvement.

MENTORSHIP
Pairing with experienced volunteers or staff for guidance and support.

CONCLUSION

We are excited to have you join our volunteer leadership team here at Garden City Church. Your commitment and service are vital to our mission, and we are committed to your growth and success, no matter your role. We pray that you will grow in your faith and find joy in serving God and our community.

Thank you for your dedication and service. Together, we can make significant impact for the Kingdom of God!



Garden City Church
www.gardencitychurch.net
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